

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 4 3
♥ J 10 5 2
♦ K 2
♣ J 6 4

♠ Q J 10

♥ A Q

♦ 10 8 7

♣ A Q 10 9 5



♠ A K 2

♥ 9 7 6 3

♦ A 6 4 3

♣ 7 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ K 8 4

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ K 8 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Of course you open 1NT. Partner responds 2NT.

With 15 points you decline invitations, and with 17 points you accept. But with 16 you have to use your judgement. Some players will just automatically bid 3NT when they have 16 points, preferring to err on the side of boldness than to possibly miss bidding a makeable game. Others prefer to base their decision on how good the hand looks.

With all the 10s and 9s this hand is stronger than 16 points, so you bid 3NT.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 3
♥ A K 7
♦ 10 8 2
♣ Q 10 7 5

♠ 9 8 7 4 2

♥ 10 5 3

♦ 3

♣ K 6 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 10 5
♥ Q 9 8
♦ A Q 4
♣ A 9 8

♠ 6

♥ J 6 4 2

♦ K J 9 7 6 5

♣ J 3

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

4NT

All Pass

4NT by East

You open 1NT. Again. This time partner jumps to 4NT.

Partner's bid is **not** Blackwood. It is called a Quantitative 4NT and he is telling you he has a balanced 16-17 point hand. He is inviting you to bid 6NT.

With 17 you accept invitations, with 15 you decline. You have 15 so you pass.

As you see, there are 9 easy tricks and you can probably set up another. But you have no chance to make slam.